Gmail

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Reflections from Beyond the Bend

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Mon, Nov 10, 2025 at 2:32 PM
Reply-To: laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca
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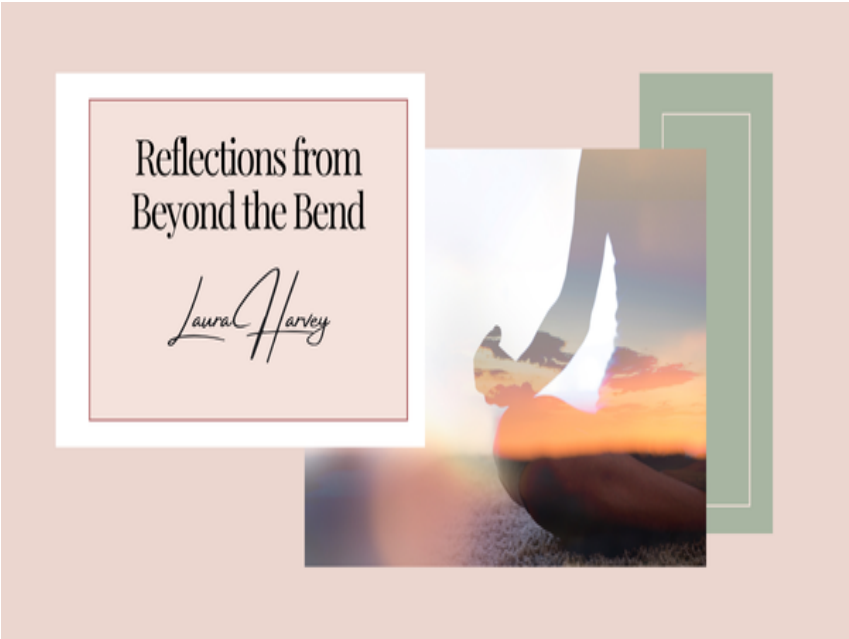
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hi Laura

I've been sitting with something tender lately. I recently attended a workshop that invited me to build a relationship with my past selves - not just to remember them, but to truly *meet* them. It was a surprisingly emotional experience, one that opened up quiet corners of memory I didn't realize were still waiting to be seen.

Since then, I've found myself reflecting on all the versions of me that have lived within this one body - the bright and curious little girl who learned to stay small and invisible, the teenager who wanted to be fearless but ended up feeling shame for shining, the woman who's learned to begin again, again and again. I've been wondering what they might say to me now, and what I might say back.

Somewhere in that reflection, my grandmother came to mind - the one who first placed *Women Who Run With the Wolves* in my hands. I've been thinking about how her strength, curiosity, and wisdom still move through me in ways I couldn't see before. So I want to dedicate this newsletter to her - and to all the women who came before us, and all the versions of ourselves we're still becoming.

This week's reflections and practice come from that place - from the quiet space between memory and becoming, where healing often begins.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

✨ Edmonton Friends:
A Mid-Week Morning Sanctuary Awaits

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

Time Traveling Through the Heart

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

My grandmother was the one who first gave me *Women Who Run With the Wolves.*
Her copy still sits on my bookshelf, worn soft at the edges, filled with her handwriting and tiny tabs marking the passages that must have stirred her soul. Every now and then, I take it down and read the lines she underlined - the ones she must have felt in her bones. When I do, it feels like I'm time-traveling, not through years or places, but through my heart.

In her notes, I hear the younger version of her - fierce, curious, still reaching for something unnamed. And I see my own younger self reflected there too: the girl who wanted to be brave but also deeply loved, the one who didn't yet know that both could coexist.

Clarissa Pinkola Estés writes about the *wild woman* - that instinctive part of us that knows when it's time to return home to ourselves. When I reread my grandmother's thoughts, I realize that wildness isn't only in how we break free; it's also in how we remember - how we stay loyal to the parts of ourselves we once tucked away to survive.

This, to me, is what it means to time-travel through the heart:
to sit quietly and feel the echo of all the women we've ever been - the child, the dreamer, the caretaker, the seeker - and to recognize that each of them still lives within us. Their voices blend into a chorus of wisdom, guiding us home to ourselves.

And when we slow down long enough to meet them, we begin to understand that these inner versions of ourselves aren't gone - they're simply waiting to be acknowledged. The tender one who learned to please. The fiery one who once spoke too boldly and retreated in shame. The hopeful one who still believes in magic.
When we sit beside them, with curiosity instead of criticism, something softens. The tension between who we were and who we are begins to ease.

It's a kind of gentle inner reunion, a remembering that healing doesn't mean erasing our past selves but listening to them, holding them close, and letting them know they still belong. Each one carries a fragment of our aliveness, and when we welcome them back, our hearts expand.

Perhaps that's what my grandmother knew when she passed that book into my hands that one day, I'd read her notes not just as her story, but as my own. That through her words, I'd learn that healing is less about becoming someone new, and more about remembering who we've always been.

💌 Practice of the Week: A Letter to Your Future Self

There's something extraordinary about putting your present-day heart into words, not as a plan or a checklist, but as a small act of remembering who you are right now.

We often wonder what our future selves might say to us, but what if we turned that around? What if *we* were the ones leaving breadcrumbs of insight for the woman we're still becoming?

Imagine if your eight-year-old self had written you a letter. What might she have said? What would she have dreamed of, feared, or hoped for? Or your teenage self - full of intensity, courage, and contradiction - what would she have wanted you to remember?

Wouldn't it be incredible to hold those letters now, to see how far you've come, how much you've carried, and how beautifully you've grown?
That's the gift you're giving your future self when you write to her - a record of this very moment, this chapter of your becoming.

✍️ Write a Letter to "Future You"

Choose a moment in time - a month, a year, or even a decade from now - and write a letter to your future self. There's no wrong way to do this. What matters is that it comes from your heart.

Here are some gentle questions to guide you:

- What do you most want your future self to remember about this season of your life?
- What truths are you beginning to see more clearly now?
- What do you hope will unfold — in your relationships, your health, your work, or your spirit?
- What do you want her to know when life feels uncertain?
- What would make you proud to read years from now?

You might even want to invite your younger selves into the process — imagine how each of them would answer these questions. Let their voices mingle with your own.

🌙 A Few Gentle Details

Timeline: Choose how far into the future you want the letter to travel - a month, a year, or even a decade.

Format: Handwritten or typed - either is perfect. (Though there's something

Format: Handwritten or typed – either is perfect. (Though there's something sacred about holding your own words on paper, years later.)

Keep it safe: Seal it in an envelope or store it somewhere special, or entrust it to a friend to deliver at your chosen date.

When that day arrives, open it slowly. Notice what has changed, and what has stayed timeless within you.

Because healing, I've come to believe, isn't about becoming someone new.
It's about finally coming home to everyone you've ever been. 🌿

✨ Current Classes

🌸 Sherwood Park - Rising Moon Studio

Evening Classes

- **Monday Evenings – Somatic Vinyasa (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 3 – December 15***
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- **Tuesday Evenings – Restore and Reclaim (6:00–7:15 p.m.)**
  Next 7-week session: ***November 4 – December 16 (Full)***

Morning Classes

- **Tuesday Mornings – Rise and Restore (10:00–11:15 a.m.)**
  October 21 – December 16 (9-week series)

  Drop-ins are available for Current Classes - Please Contact Laura at laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Please note: If you'd like to join after the session has begun, your fee can be **prorated** based on the remaining classes.

You're always welcome to reach out to **Laura** at **laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca** to confirm your total and find the best option for you. 💗

Learn More and Sign-up

🌙 A Closing Thought

As always, thank you for showing up - not just here, but for yourself. Every time you open this space, you add to its calm and its light. I'm so glad we're walking this journey together.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

Our e-mail address is:
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